

Case Study Title: Strained at the Seams: Job Satisfaction Challenges Among Garment Managers in Bangladesh

Background

The ready-made garments (RMG) industry is the lifeline of Bangladesh's economy, accounting for a significant portion of the country's export earnings. With buyers from the US, Europe, and other parts of the world placing large orders, the industry operates on tight deadlines and demanding standards. Behind the glossy numbers lie complex organizational behavior challenges, especially when it comes to the well-being and job satisfaction of its mid- to upper-level managers.

Case Context

Nasir Ahmed is a production manager at a mid-sized garment factory in Gazipur, one of the major garment hubs in Bangladesh. Every day begins early and ends late. With clients from three different time zones, Nasir often finds himself on calls at midnight or even later. These irregular hours have been affecting his family life. His wife complains about him not being present for important family events, and his two children have started to avoid asking for his time, knowing he's either too busy or too tired.

The pressure to meet shipment deadlines means frequent overtime, often without proper breaks. Despite being a senior manager, Nasir has little control over the pace and planning of work due to the volatile demands of global clients. Even weekends are not guaranteed off-days, especially during peak seasons. This is not just Nasir's story — similar experiences are echoed by many managers across the industry.

There is a high turnover rate in managerial positions, and those who stay often show signs of burnout, disengagement, and declining motivation. Senior executives in the companies recognize the problem, but often feel

constrained by the nature of the global supply chain and buyer expectations.

Discussion Questions

1. What factors are contributing to the job dissatisfaction among managers in the Bangladeshi garments industry?
2. How does the current work environment affect the work-life balance and overall well-being of managers?
3. What role does organizational culture play in shaping employee satisfaction in this industry?
4. How can job satisfaction issues be effectively addressed in the context of the Bangladeshi garments industry, considering both organizational constraints and employee needs?